

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | SIEM, EDR/XDR, Threat Hunting, Incident Response and Azure Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of experience in enterprise Security Operations Centre (SOC) environments, specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)/Extended Detection and Response (XDR), threat hunting, threat modelling, incident response, and vulnerability management. I have a strong track record of monitoring and investigating complex cyber security alerts, leading incident response activities through the full lifecycle, and conducting structured threat hunting exercises informed by MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis. My current role at the University of the Arts London gives me hands-on experience across Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Azure security, Entra ID/Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI). I hold a solid understanding of security frameworks including NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, and CIS Controls, and I am experienced in driving security best practice and security-by-design principles across change projects. I am keen to bring this operational depth to a global professional services environment where I can help shape and mature enterprise-wide cyber security operations.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM:** CrowdStrike Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), Splunk/SPL
- **EDR / XDR:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM) - Expert; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Threat Hunting and Threat Modelling:** MITRE ATT&CK Framework, hypothesis-driven hunts, gap analysis-driven detection rule creation
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 full lifecycle (Detection, Analysis, Containment, Eradication, Recovery, Lessons Learned)
- **SOC Operations:** Alert triage, investigation, escalation, root cause analysis; playbook development
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Microsoft Azure Security:** Entra ID, Azure AD, Conditional Access, Microsoft Defender for Cloud; Azure infrastructure protection
- **Identity Protection:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Azure AD Identity Protection, Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **IDS / IPS:** Intrusion Detection System / Intrusion Prevention System management and tuning
- **Firewalls:** Check Point Harmony, perimeter and network security policy management
- **Email Security:** Mimecast gateway management, phishing investigation, Business Email Compromise (BEC) analysis
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, KQL; Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Security-by-Design:** Embedding security controls into infrastructure and change initiatives

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Monitor, investigate, and respond to cyber security alerts and incidents across an 8,000-user enterprise environment using CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel

- Lead incident response activities through the full NIST 800-61 lifecycle: detection, analysis, containment, eradication, recovery, and lessons learned; produce post-incident reports and update playbooks accordingly
- Conduct structured threat hunting exercises informed by MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis and threat intelligence feeds, converting findings into detection rules and tuning recommendations
- Perform threat modelling on new services and infrastructure changes, ensuring security-by-design principles are embedded in every change initiative
- Write and tune KQL detection rules within Microsoft Sentinel to improve detection fidelity and reduce alert fatigue
- Manage vulnerability remediation programmes using Tenable.io, Nessus, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), coordinating remediation with infrastructure stakeholders
- Provide security guidance across infrastructure and change projects, advising on Azure security controls, conditional access, and identity protections
- Maintain and improve operational documentation, security runbooks, and incident response playbooks
- Develop and deliver security awareness training to staff, driving security-conscious culture across the organisation
- Drive cyber security operational improvements, supporting maturity assessments aligned to NIST CSF and ISO 27001

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and triaged alerts across CrowdStrike Falcon and Microsoft Sentinel, performing detailed investigations and escalating significant incidents to senior analysts
- Supported the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, improving XDR coverage and identity-based threat detection
- Contributed to detection engineering by writing KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel and tuning CrowdStrike alert thresholds to reduce false positives
- Performed vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, tracking findings through to remediation and producing risk reports for stakeholders
- Participated in incident response activities, assisting with containment, eradication, and post-incident reviews
- Managed Mimecast email security gateway policies and investigated phishing and BEC campaigns
- Supported Entra ID/Azure AD Conditional Access policy updates and MFA enforcement rollouts
- Contributed to the development of security playbooks and operational documentation

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Supported security operations for a Software as a Service (SaaS)/FinTech environment, including endpoint protection, infrastructure hardening, and access control management
- Administered network firewalls and maintained security perimeter controls, ensuring policy alignment with security standards
- Assisted in vulnerability scanning, patch management, and remediation tracking processes
- Supported identity and access management reviews, MFA configuration, and user provisioning

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users at UAL, substantially improving XDR coverage and enabling identity-based threat detection at scale
- Developed and automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks that reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) to high-frequency alert types, freeing analyst capacity for complex investigations
- Led Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises, validating security controls against real-world attack techniques and using findings to mature the detection and response programme
- Built a structured threat hunting capability using MITRE ATT&CK gap analysis, converting hunt findings directly into new detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike

- Maintained UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification through continuous vulnerability management and control assurance across a complex hybrid infrastructure

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)